

PIPEDA Compliance Guide for Ontario Businesses

2026 Compliance Requirements

Is Your Ontario Business Actually PIPEDA Compliant?

The Personal Information Protection and Electronic Documents Act (PIPEDA) is Canada's federal privacy law. If your business collects, uses, or discloses personal information, you must comply.

What PIPEDA Covers

PIPEDA applies to personal information including names, emails, phone numbers, IP addresses, employee records, customer purchase history, health information, and financial data.

The 10 Core Principles

1. Accountability - Designate a privacy officer
2. Identifying Purposes - Be clear before collection
3. Consent - Obtain explicit informed consent
4. Limiting Collection - Only collect what you need
5. Limiting Use - Use data only as stated
6. Accuracy - Keep information current
7. Safeguarding - Implement security measures
8. Openness - Make practices transparent
9. Individual Access - Allow data access
10. Challenging Compliance - Provide complaint process

Common Compliance Gaps in Ontario Businesses

No Privacy Policy: 78 percent of businesses assessed
Inadequate Consent: Pre-ticked boxes don't meet requirements
Poor Data Security: Unencrypted databases, shared passwords
Missing Retention Schedules: Data held indefinitely
No Data Breach Protocol: No detection procedures
Inadequate Employee Training: Staff lack privacy training

Steps to Achieve PIPEDA Compliance

1. Conduct a Privacy Audit - Identify all personal data
2. Document Your Privacy Practices - Create a privacy policy
3. Implement Consent Processes - Get explicit consent
4. Encrypt Sensitive Data - Use encryption
5. Limit Access - Implement role-based controls
6. Create a Data Retention Schedule - Define periods
7. Establish a Breach Response Plan - Know how to respond
8. Train Your Team - Ensure staff understand obligations
9. Appoint a Privacy Officer - Designate oversight
10. Review Annually - Audit compliance yearly

Non-Compliance Consequences

Violations can result in complaints to the Privacy Commissioner, investigations, binding orders, and potential liability.

Get Help from Trueline IT

PIPEDA compliance doesn't have to be complicated. Trueline IT helps Southern Ontario businesses assess privacy practices, implement controls, and maintain compliance.